

REMOVING STARS FROM A STRING

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IBM

Walmart

| Problem Statement

given a string s , contains stars $*$

In one op:

- choose a star
- remove star + one non star char to its left

return string, once all stars removed

| Example

Eg: aa^*dy^*a

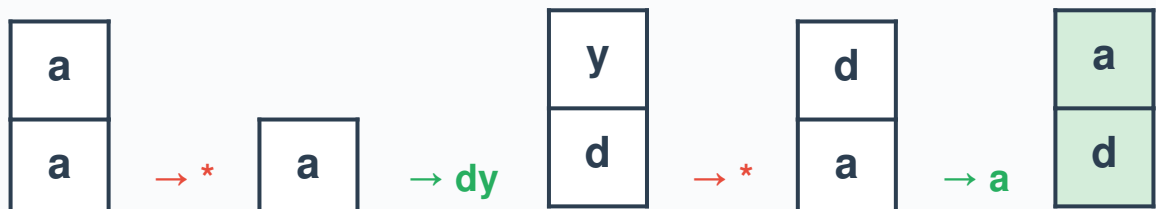
→ **ada**

(a^ and y^* were removed)*

| Key Intuition

whenever a incoming char leads to removal of top most char, think of stack

| Stack Execution Trace



→ now store only in a string and return

| Code Implementation

```
class Solution {
public:
    string removeStars(string s) {

        stack<char> st;

        for(char c:s){
            if(c=='*'){
                if(!st.empty()){
                    st.pop();
                }
            }
            else{
                st.push(c);
            }
        }

        string ans="";
        while(!st.empty()){
            ans+=st.top();
            st.pop();
        }

        reverse(ans.begin(),ans.end());
        return ans;
    }
};
```